

2B JOANNE CHING YIN XUAN.pdf

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Topic: Bridging the Gap: The Role of Experiential Learning in Higher Education for Career Readiness

Group: 2

Reading and Writing Process Template

References	Key Ideas	Critical Analysis	Synthesis / Summary / Paraphrase	Comparison/Contrast	Similarity/Difference
Sharma, A., & Naidu, A. Title: Bridging the Industry–Academia Gap: An Experiential Learning for Engineering Students Publication Year: 2023 Source: Springer	Integration of industrial FMEA into engineering education through experiential co-curricular activities. Students engage in team-based problem-solving mirroring industry practices.	Strengths: Offers a practical framework for bringing industry methodologies into education Weaknesses: It is mainly focused on engineering field, lack of other field Relevance: Shows how higher education can collaborate with companies to help	Sharma and Naidu (2023) highlighted the importance of including real world industry practices, like Failure Mode and Effects Analysis (FMEA) into engineering education. For example such as creating an experiential learning space that replicates authentic job challenges of students. The study emphasizes the importance of collaborative, team-oriented problem-solving exercises to prepare students for professional purposes. Through the integration of collaborative course activities that mimic industry processes, student gain the technical and soft skills needed to succeed professionally. The research is focused on the field of engineering that underscore the broader application of experiential learning paradigms that accurately connect higher	More focused on industry collaboration than Celio et al. (2011), aligns with Okolie (2022) on the importance of real-world experience in preparing students for employment.	Similar to Okolie (2022) in emphasizing experiential learning's impact on employability through practical experience; differs from Celio et al. (2011) by centering on industry processes rather than community-based service learning.

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		students be more prepared for jobs	education materials with industry demands, making possible the transition required from theory to practice. This approach enables the gain of skilled competency which is tailored to meet the employers' requirements, solving the problem of graduates' career readiness.		
Okolie, U. C. Title: Work placement learning and students' readiness for school-to-work transition: Do perceived employability and faculty supervisor support matter? Publication Year: 2022 Source: Journal of Vocational Behavior	Work placements enhance students' readiness for the workforce. - Self-efficacy and perceived employability mediate this relationship. - Faculty supervisor support plays a moderating role.	Strengths: Empirical evidence supporting the benefits of work placements. Weaknesses: Study limited to specific contexts; broader applicability may vary. Relevance: Highlights the critical role of structured mentorship and support in experiential learning.	Okolie (2022) provides empirical evidence on the value of structured work placements in building students' employability and confidence in the school-to-work transition. The study illustrates that self-efficacy and students' perceptions of their employability are key mediators bridging experiential work learning and career readiness. It also points out that mentoring from faculty supervisors' makes the experience better. This research also shows the merit of internship mentorship give students career-related benefits. The findings align with calls for strong industry partnerships and good supervision systems to render experiential learning meaningful and attentive to students' future career needs. The study also brings out that placement should not only give students job exposure but also help students learn effectively	Emphasizes structured mentorship more than Sharma and Naidu (2023); contrasts with Celio et al. (2011) by focusing on workplace placements rather than academic credit for community engagement.	Similar to Sharma and Naidu (2023) in highlighting the value of hands-on experience and mentorship; differs from Celio et al. (2011) in focusing on industry placements rather than service-learning models.

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Spanjaard, D., Hall, T., & Stegemann, N. Title: Experiential Learning: Helping Students to Become 'Career-Ready' Publication Year: 2018 Source: Journal of Teaching in Travel & Tourism	Experiential learning bridges the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application. It helps students' employability by developing soft skills and real-world competencies.	Strengths: Provides a clear overview of experiential learning benefits. Weaknesses: Lack of specific implementation strategies. Relevance: Supports the integration of experiential methods to get student ready for their career	Spanjaard, Hall, and Stegemann (2018) discuss experiential learning as a crucial educational approach that closes the gap between theory in education and application in the workplace. They point out how experiential experiences develop important soft skills such as communication, teamwork, and problem-solving, which are most sought by employers. The article recommends infusing such experiences into curricula for enhancing the job preparedness and employability of students. Although not providing concrete implementation directions, it supports the contention that experiential education is an imperative form of preparation to prepare graduates to meet the shifting needs of today's job market and is consistent with imperatives for placing education in a more practical and vocationally directed path.	Shares a broad view of experiential learning benefits with Celio et al. (2011); less focused on structured mentorship and placements than Okolie (2022) or Sharma and Naidu (2023).	Similar to Celio et al. (2011) in promoting the overall value of experiential learning; differs from Okolie (2022) by not emphasizing structured placements or mentorship specifically.
NACE Staff Title: Impacts of Experiential Learning on the Gen Z Early Career Experience Publication Year: 2025 Source: NACE	Experiential learning leads to more job offers and higher starting salaries for Gen Z graduates. Emphasizes importance of hands-on	Strengths: Provides current data on the positive outcomes of experiential learning. Weaknesses: Focus primarily	The NACE report (2025) provides current data that illustrates the beneficial impact experiential learning has on Gen Z graduates' early career success in terms of increased numbers of job offers and first-year salaries. The report emphasizes the importance of applied, experiential learning as key components of career readiness. Prioritizing short-term outcomes, the report highlights the value of live-in learning	Aligns with Okolie (2022) on empirical evidence of experiential learning benefits; broader in scope than Sharma and Naidu (2023) by addressing generational workforce trends rather than	Similar to Okolie (2022) in providing empirical support for career benefits of experiential learning; differs from Sharma and Naidu (2023) in focusing on overall labor market outcomes

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	experiences in career preparation.	on short-term outcomes. Relevance: Validates the effectiveness of experiential learning in enhancing employability.	experiences that prepare students for the demands of the workforce and employer expectations. This source is best suited in understanding how experiential learning shapes career trajectories in the modern world of work and making the case for the infusion of such practices in higher education to close graduates' career readiness gaps.	specific industry practices.	for a specific generation.
Celio, C. I., Durlak, J., & Dymnicki, A. Title: Effectiveness of Service-Learning in Higher Education: A Meta-Analysis Publication Year: 2011 Source: Michigan Journal of Community Service Learning	Academic credit for community-based work enhances student engagement, learning outcomes, and career readiness. Service-learning connects academic learning with real-world community issues.	Strength: Meta-analytic evidence supports service-learning benefits. Weaknesses: Slightly older study but highly relevant. Relevance: Directly supports offering academic credit for community-based work aligning with career readiness.	Celio, Durlak, and Dymnicki (2011) offer a meta-analysis stating that service-learning when connected with academic credit firmly boosts student motivation, and preparation for life following graduation. The study highlights how community-based activity ensures that classroom instruction gets connected with the very problem-solving occurring in the world, which gets translated into being more applicable, accessible, and relevant to students' future careers. This proof strongly supports the idea that experiential community service credit supports deeper learning and workforce readiness, a fact that emphasizes the need to integrate such programs into higher education. The thorough review justifies service-learning as a reliable means of bridging the disconnect between educational experiences and career needs	More focused on academic credit and community engagement than Sharma and Naidu (2023) or Okolie (2022), complements Spanjaard et al. (2018) in highlighting experiential learning's broad benefits.	Similar to Spanjaard et al. (2018) in emphasizing experiential learning's general benefits; differs from Sharma and Naidu (2023) in focusing on community service rather than industry collaboration.

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